

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 99 Handout — Pricing is a boundary you write privately — this series stays a classroom

10 - Portfolio & Public Launch · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — communication vs selling (this series is the former)

Move	Educational use	Out of scope here
Public walkthrough link	Share demo-shipboard + the case study	A product SKU, a 'health check' package, a brand offer
DM template	Offer to answer questions about a public article	Cold 'hire me' + calendar spam
Rate band	Private note: what an hour of your time is worth to you	A published price card on LinkedIn
Who you write to	People already asking about Azure Pipelines (rare, specific)	Mass DMs on every hiring post
Proof	The repo a stranger can clone	A rate without a public artifact

Architecture B — a thinking exercise for independent engineers

Question (private)	Undercharging buys	Overcharging without proof buys
What would I charge myself to redo this capstone?	Stress and resentful yeses	Silence — no one replies
What evidence exists today?	A low number with only a hello pipeline	A high number with no README
Hour vs outcome?	Endless unpaid Slack	A fixed fee you cannot scope
Do I even want paid work?	A rate you write and never use	A profile that violates Day 98 policy
Will I publish the number?	No — the band stays in a private file	A fake day rate to look senior

Architecture C — pitfalls that turn a classroom into a storefront

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
Spam tax	Fifty identical DMs	Two templates, used rarely or never
Hire-me on the lesson post	Calendar link under a Day 99 PDF	This series has no sales CTA
Packaged 'assessment' sell	A branded checkup offer on the handout	Do not. Learning content only
Invented market rate	A number copied from a tweet	Private band + your actual proof
Prospecting a workplace	DMs aimed at an employer's customers	Never. Independent thinking exercise only

One-liner to remember

Pricing is a boundary — undercharging buys stress, overcharging without proof buys silence.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Educational thinking exercise for independent engineers. Personal notes only. No sales PDF, no packaged offer, no outreach blast from this lesson.

- 1 Write two DM templates in a private file (docs/outreach-draft-day99.md, keep the repo private or omit this file from the public GitHub copy).
- 2 Template vibe: you published a public CI/CD walkthrough; here is the link; happy to answer questions. No 'hire me', no calendar, no packaged assessment.

- 3 Write a private rate band as a thinking exercise: a floor that does not buy you stress, a ceiling you could defend with the capstone. Do not publish the numbers.
- 4 Note whether Day 98 policy even allows paid work. If no, the templates stay unused — that is a complete lab.
- 5 Do not drop the DMs on today's LinkedIn post. Do not mass-message hiring threads.
- 6 Do not invent a day rate to look senior. Do not attach a service menu to this series.

Template vibe — help first; numbers stay private

```
# Private draft only – do not paste rates on LinkedIn.  
# DM A: "Saw you are hiring for Azure Pipelines. I published a public  
# CI/CD walkthrough here: <github-or-case-study>. Happy to answer questions."  
# DM B: "Wrote up how I promote one artifact across two personal Azure envs:  
# <link>. If useful, the repo has the YAML."  
# Rate band: <floor>–<ceiling> in a file that is NOT in the public repo.  
# This series is a classroom. No service menu. No packaged checkup offer.
```

Done checklist

- Two help-first DM templates written privately
- Private rate band written and not published
- No hire-me CTA, no packaged offer, no mass DM
- Policy from Day 98 still respected
- This handout stays educational

Tomorrow — Day 100

Launch day — pin the proof, destroy leftovers, write the next 100 days